

months for \$23. Though the project is still in its early stages, the gadget certainly looks promising.

Google starts converting YouTube videos to the open source format

Google has started to convert its huge catalogue of YouTube videos to the open source format, WebM. Earlier, the videos supported H.264, a format backed by Apple. Since Apple does not allow Adobe's Flash in its iPod touch, iPhone or the iPad, the only way to watch videos via YouTube when on an Apple mobile device is to use the codec H.264.

As of now, around 30 per cent of the videos on YouTube have been converted to the WebM format. To speed up the process of transcoding, Google has been utilising its famed cloud infrastructure. Whenever there is too much traffic or users need to upload content, the WebM transcoding is paused.

But it isn't like Google is totally abandoning the H.264 format, which happens to be more popular since it offers hardware acceleration, something that is currently non-existent in the WebM format.



Canonical switches to OpenStack for the cloud

At the Ubuntu Developer Summit in Budapest, Hungary, Canonical and the Ubuntu developers announced their decision to focus solely on OpenStack as the foundation technology of the Ubuntu Cloud platform.

It was announced that OpenStack will be moved to being a core part of the Ubuntu Cloud product, which enables users to build an open source cloud. The current releases of Ubuntu Enterprise Cloud (UEC), which is based on Eucalyptus, are not impacted. Eucalyptus will continue to be available for download and will be supported by Canonical. This means that customers who have deployed private clouds based on existing Ubuntu releases will continue to receive maintenance, and in the case of Ubuntu 10.04 LTS, this will continue through to April 2015.

Android Open Conference launched

O'Reilly Media has announced a new Android Open Conference, which is billed as "...the first conference to cover the entire Android ecosystem." Scheduled for October 9-11,

2011 at the Hyatt Regency, San Francisco, it is designed for anyone who creates, sells or markets Android-related products. O'Reilly Media expects the conference to be a big-tent meeting ground for app and game developers, carriers, chip manufacturers, content creators, OEMs, researchers, entrepreneurs, VCs, and business leaders to share best practices, tools, models, and lessons learned.



MTS India's free Android phone offer

As part of its plan to increase its market presence, MTS, one of the CDMA operators in India, has come up with an interesting scheme. Subscribers need to pay just Rs 1500 per month over a period of one year to get HTC's latest Android phone, the Pulse, for free. The package would include 1500 minutes of talk value, 1500 local and national SMSs and 1500 MB worth of data usage every month. The phone sports Android 2.1, an 81.3 mm multi-touchscreen, an 8 GB memory card, a 5 MP camera and a back-stand for video/movie watching convenience.



Chrome: 160 million users and counting

Google's Chrome Web browser now has 160 million active users. Its total user base "more than doubled" in the past year with browser adoption increasing from 70 million to 160 million, thanks to Linux, Windows, and OS X versions of the browser finally reaching parity, according to Sundar Pichai, senior vice president of Chrome.



The browser is now at version 12, up from version 5 in May 2010. Pichai explains that the company decided to change to a six-week release cycle to make sure that users have the most advanced browser technology at their fingertips. Some major improvements are being planned over the next few months, including speech support built into the browser as well as more developer APIs to improve user interaction.